

IN MINISTRY OF
COOPERATION
UNDER DEPARTMENT OF
FISHERIES (FIDF)

PURPOSE

The Fisheries and Aquaculture Infrastructure Development Fund (FIDF) is a specialized structural framework created by the Department of Fisheries under the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying, Government of India. The foundational purpose of this scheme is to address critical gaps in the nationwide fisheries value chain by facilitating massive investments in modern infrastructure facilities.

The fund plays a strategic role in

augmenting the country's overall fish production capabilities across both marine and inland fisheries sectors. By upgrading traditional capture and culture practices through commercial infrastructure development, the fund aims to achieve sustainable socio-economic growth and drive technological modernization across all operations.

2. ELIGIBLE ENTITIES AND BENEFICIARIES

A broad category of stakeholders can access concessional financing under current FIDF guidelines. Eligible entities include State Governments, Union Territories, and State-Owned Corporations or undertakings.

Fisheries Cooperative Federations, Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS), and individual fish farmers are highly encouraged to participate. Additionally, private companies, entrepreneurs, Self-Help Groups (SHGs), Joint Liability Groups, and non-governmental organizations qualify directly for institutional credit support to build commercial fishing infrastructure assets.

3. PERMISSIBLE **INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS**

The fund covers a comprehensive array of core development projects. Funding is primarily directed toward the establishment of state-of-the-art fishing harbors,

modernized fish landing centers, and advanced mariculture infrastructure like ocean farming cages.

Eligible activities also encompass ice plants, deep cold storage units, integrated cold chain logistics network distribution facilities, automated fish feed mills, modern fish retail markets, disease diagnostic laboratories, aquatic quarantine facilities, and high-tech fish hatcheries designed to optimize production systems.

4. SCHEME BENEFITS **AND CONCESSIONAL** **FINANCE**

FIDF offers highly favorable financial assistance terms to ensure project viability. Beneficiaries receive a substantial interest

subsidy of up to 3% per annum from the Department of Fisheries, provided the effective lending rate remains at least 5% per annum.

The scheme facilitates long-term credit funding up to 80% of the total estimated project cost. Loans feature a maximum repayment timeline of 12 years, which explicitly includes a comfortable 2-year moratorium period on the repayment of the principal amount, lowering initial strain.

5. STEP-BY-STEP APPLICATION PROCEDURE

Step 1: Formulate a detailed project proposal matching official investment standards.

Step 2: Route the application through the designated Nodal Department of your respective State Government or Union Territory administration.

Step 3: Private sector companies and individual entrepreneurs can submit their proposals directly to the National Fisheries Development Board (NFDB). Step 4: The Central Approval and Monitoring Committee evaluates the feasibility of the project. Step 5: Approved projects receive loan clearance via Nodal Loaning Entities.

6. REQUIRED CHECKLIST AND DOCUMENTATION

Applicants must provide a thoroughly compiled Detailed Project Report (DPR)

detailing all technical and financial parameters. Valid land ownership records, title deeds, or official long-term registered lease agreements are mandatory to prove site readiness.

The documentation pack must also feature verified component cost estimates based on the current Schedule of Rates, detailed structural engineering drawings, itemized vendor machinery quotations, statutory environmental clearances, bank credentials, and official entity registration papers.

7. FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (FAQS)

Question: What exactly is FIDF?

Answer: A dedicated central sector funding

mechanism built to support robust post-harvest and farm-gate fisheries infrastructure investment nationwide.

Question: Who can obtain financing?

Answer: State entities, private corporations, marginal fish farmers, and cooperatives.

Question: Can a cooperative proceed?

Answer: Yes, cooperatives apply by routing an approved project DPR via their local state fisheries nodal department or NCDC channels.